

RNLI LOCAL OPERATING PROCEDURE**Teddington Lifeboat Station – Local Knowledge****7.5-1 Ashore****7.5-2 Afloat****Objective**

To ensure that all operational personnel are familiar with the area of operations of the Station, and to ensure safe navigation and operations, both afloat and ashore. Areas in square brackets are out of normal operations but may occasionally be areas of operation.

Validation

ID Number	LOP Teddington 002 Local Knowledge Ashore + Afloat	Original Approval Date	April 2018
Version	3.0	Review Frequency	Biennial
Author	Jon Chapman (LTA/Helm)	Next Review Date	April 2025
Approved by	Wayne Bellamy (Station Manager)	Pages	8
Department Sponsor	Head of Lifeboats	Director Sponsor	Director of Lifesaving Operations

Reference Documentation

Station Risk Assessment	TP-LB-04 Coxswain/Helm Handbook
TP-SC-01 Shore Crew Handbook	TP-LB-24 D Class Manual
TP-LB-01 Crew Member Handbook	CoBT 7.5-1,-2
TP-LB-03 Mechanics Handbook	PLA Notices to Mariners

Hazards

Manual Handling	Weather and sea conditions
Entrapment	Slips, trips and falls
Lines under load	

Safety, Health and Environment

 Caution	 Beware deep water	 Caution slippery surface	 Lifejackets to be worn	 Protective clothing must be worn	 Protective footwear must be worn
 Trip hazard	 Lines under load	 Beware slipway	 Safety gloves must be worn	 High visibility jacket must be worn	 Hard hat area

Evacuation Points (from furthest downstream)	TIDAL [Slipway by the London Apprentice, Church Street, Isleworth] White Cross Hotel Slip, Water Lane, Richmond Richmond Bridge Slip (upstream/East Twickenham side) Richmond Canoe Club River Lane, Petersham Ham House Car Park White Swan beach, Riverside, Twickenham Eel Pie Footbridge, Water Lane, Twickenham Lifeboat Station NON-TIDAL Teddington Lock (off Riverside Drive, but refer to “Duke’s Avenue” to LCG/LAS) Albany Park Canoe and Sailing Centre, Lower Ham Road, Kingston Kingston (“Steadfast”) Sea Cadet Corps, Thames Side, Kingston Steps on Barge Walk, opposite side of river from Charter Quay, Kingston (150m upstream of bridge) Town End Pier, High Street, Kingston (Turk Launches) Slip between London River Yacht Club and Thames Sailing Club, Portsmouth Road, Surbiton Ditton Reach Slip, Thames Ditton (off Portsmouth Road) <i>(NOTE: Ferry Road does not meet the river directly, access only via the locked private pontoon. Ditton Reach has public slip. Approx 100 metres downstream Ferry Road)</i> By Thames Ditton Island Footbridge (close to Ye Olde Swan, Summer Road, Thames Ditton) Hampton Court Landing Stage (Colliers Launches) East Molesey Wharf (just upstream of bridge) (J. Martin & Son “boats for hire”)
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Islands (from furthest upstream)	Ash Island Thames Ditton Island Swan Island Boyle Farm Island Raven’s Ait Steven’s Eyot The “Tea Pots” Trowlock Island Teddington Lock Island Swan Island Eel Pie Island Glover’s Island Corporation Island The “Flower Pots” [Isleworth Ait]
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Pubs / Hotels / Bars / Restaurants	The Mitre Hotel, Hampton Court The Albany, Thames Ditton Ye Olde Swan, Thames Ditton Harts Boatyard, Surbiton Ginger Bee's Café, Queen's Promenade, Surbiton Stein's, Kingston Woody's, Kingston The Ram, Kingston Brown's, Kingston The Gazebo, Kingston The Bishop, Kingston Bill's, Kingston Chakra, Kingston Canbury Secret Café, Canbury Gardens, Kingston The Boaters Inn, Kingston The Anglers, Teddington The Wharf, Teddington The Barmy Arms, Twickenham The White Swan, Twickenham Stein's, Richmond Gaucho, Richmond Pitcher & Piano, Richmond The White Cross Hotel, Richmond [The Town Wharf, Swan Street, Isleworth] [The London Apprentice, Church Street, Isleworth]
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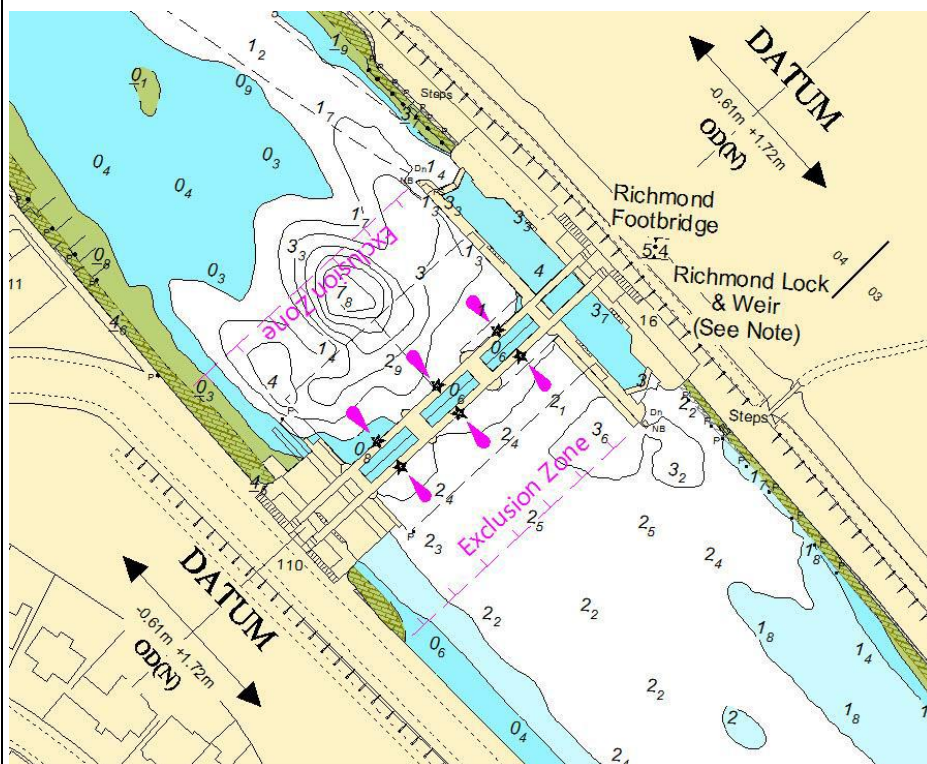
Clubs and Water Activity Centres	Thames Motor Yacht Club, East Molesey Kingston Grammar School BC, Thames Ditton BMYC, Thames Ditton Dittons Skiff and Punting Club, Thames Ditton Ajax Sea Scouts, Ditton Reach, Thames Ditton Thames Ditton Marina, Thames Ditton Harts Boatyard Boat Rental, Surbiton Thames Sailing Club, Surbiton London River Yacht Club, Surbiton Minima Yacht Club, Kingston Go Boat, Kingston Steadfast Sea Cadets, Kingston Kingston Rowing Club Small Boat Club (Steven's Eyot) Twickenham Sea Cadets, Teddington Albany Park Canoe and Sailing Centre, Kingston Surbiton High School BC, Teddington Tamesis Sailing Club, Teddington Royal Canoe Club and Walbrook RC, Trowlock Island YMCA Hawker Club, Kingston The Lensbury Thames Young Mariners, Ham Twickenham RC, Eel Pie Island Twickenham YC, Twickenham Richmond YC, Eel Pie Island Richmond Canoe Club Richmond Bridge Boat Club
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Bridges (from furthest upstream)	Hampton Court Bridge Thames Ditton Island Footbridge Kingston Bridge Kingston Rail Bridge Teddington Lock Footbridge Eel Pie Island Footbridge Richmond Bridge Twickenham Rail Bridge Twickenham Road Bridge Richmond Lock Footbridge
Roads / Parks / Rivers / Points Of Interest (from furthest upstream)	Riverbank, East Molesey Hampton Court Palace/Barge Walk Cigarette Island Park River Mole/Ember Home Park/Barge Walk Albany Reach ('Thames Ditton Beach') The River Rytte, by Ferry Road, Thames Ditton Thames Ditton Marina Queen's Promenade, Surbiton Portsmouth Road, Surbiton Town End Pier High St, Kingston Hogsmill River Kingston Turk's Pier Thames Side, Kingston Canbury Gardens, Kingston Lower Ham Road, Kingston The Rec, Teddington Broom Water, Teddington Ferry Road, Teddington Ham Lands, Ham Manor Road Rec Ground, Teddington PLA Marker Stone Mallard Place Pontoon, Twickenham Radnor Gardens, Twickenham Radnor House School, Twickenham Thames Eyot, Twickenham Embankment, Twickenham Diamond Jubilee Gardens, Twickenham Water Lane, Twickenham Champions Wharf, Twickenham St Mary's Church, Twickenham York House Gardens, Twickenham Riverside, Twickenham Ham House and Ham House Car Park Orleans Gardens, Twickenham Hammerton's Pier, Twickenham Orleans Road, Twickenham Marble Hill House and Park, Twickenham Cambridge Park, Twickenham River Lane, Petersham Petersham Meadows Buccleuch Gardens, Richmond Richmond Landing Stage Pier Water Lane, Richmond

	St Helena Pier, Richmond Old Palace Lane, Richmond Old Deer Park, Richmond Ranelagh Drive, St. Margarets [Thistleworth Marine, Isleworth] [River Crane, Isleworth] [Lion Wharf Road, Isleworth] [Duke of Northumberland's River, Isleworth] [Church Street, Isleworth]
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The Locks	Richmond Lock and Weir The weir comprises three vertical steel sluice gates suspended from a footbridge. Each gate weighs 32.6 tonnes and is 20 metres wide and 3.64 metres in depth. For around two hours each side of high tide, the sluice gates are raised into the footbridge structure above, allowing boats to pass through the barrage. At these times, 2 amber lights are shown, day and night, at each arch - weir open, free navigation. For the rest of the day, the sluice gates are closed and passing river traffic must use the lock alongside the barrage. The lock is 76m long and 8m wide and is manned 24/7. When the sluice gates are down and the weir closed, there will be three red discs in the form of an inverted triangle shown at each arch by day, and an inverted triangle of three red lights will be shown by night. The period of free navigation can be dramatically changed due to prevailing conditions. In drought conditions, the gates will be closed for longer periods, whilst in periods of high fluvial flow they may remain open for much longer. For current information, contact the Lock Foreman on 0208 940 0634. An exclusion zone is established from the extremities of the Lock Islands in a line across the river to the Middlesex shore. Mariners should not enter this zone whilst the weirs are in the lowered position or when they are being operated. Only when the weir gates are fully raised and the Closed Arch Signs have been removed is it permitted to navigate into the navigation exclusion zone and through Richmond Lock Footbridge No. 2 or No. 3 arches. Only those vessels manoeuvring on or to the Lock island berths, vessels engaged in emergency operations or smaller vessels wishing to utilise the boat rollers in No. 1 arch are exempt from this. In order to carry out essential maintenance works on Richmond lock, weirs and sluices, the weirs at Richmond are lifted for a period of approximately 3 weeks in October/November every year. This allows the river between Richmond Lock and Teddington Lock to drain down at low water on each tide. During this period, the river will NOT be maintained at the nominal level of 1.72m above Ordnance Datum Newlyn and the river bed will be exposed at low water.
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Precise information can be obtained in the applicable PLA Notice to Mariners at <http://www.pla.co.uk/Safety/Regulations-and-Guidance/Notices-to-Mariners/Notices-to-Mariners#12>



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Teddington Lock

Consists of a large, long weir and three locks: a conventional launch lock in regular use, the large barge lock and a small skiff lock. The barge lock was made to accommodate long barges, steamers or passenger ferries and has an additional set of gates half-way to operate more quickly for shorter craft. The staggered structures incorporate two reinforced narrow islands. The upper island is traversed by and accessible by the lock gates or Teddington Lock Footbridge.

Manned 24/7. Where not manned for any reason, refer to applicable Teddington LOP re Lock Operation.

The weir presents a very significant hazard, particularly in flood conditions, and considerable care needs to be taken to avoid being drawn into the sluices.

Hazards / Warnings

General

PLA WARNING FLAG SYSTEM

The PLA operate a flag system to warn about potentially fast ebb tidal flows (where the flow is increased because of higher fluvial (non-tidal) flow.

With each flag warning, the following advice will be issued, which all recreational craft users are required to consider carefully before venturing onto the tidal Thames:

 Extreme Caution – EBB TIDE Very Strong Fluvial Flows

Fluvial flows are very strong. Conditions are difficult/dangerous.

All man-powered vessels advised not to go afloat on the ebb tide.

 Caution – EBB TIDE Strong Fluvial Flows

All river users of man-powered vessels should navigate with extreme caution & consider whether it is safe for them to go afloat on the ebb tide.

PLA advise man-powered vessels - in particular schools, novices, junior crews - or those that do not usually use the tidal Thames not to go afloat on the ebb tide.

 Average Fluvial Flows

All river users to navigate with caution and maintain a proper look out.

In addition, there will be a fourth level for all river users to note, which is when there are low fluvial flows:

 Caution - Low Fluvial Flows

BLACK Tidal flow is lower than usual. River users should expect lower than predicted tides especially around low water.

ENVIRONMENT AGENCY WARNING SYSTEM

Warning boards may be displayed at locks to inform river users of the conditions.

When red boards **(CAUTION STRONG STREAM)** are displayed on lock gates, they advise users of all boats not to navigate because the strong flows make it difficult and dangerous.

When yellow boards **(CAUTION STREAM INCREASING)** are displayed on lock gates, they advise users of all unpowered boats not to navigate and users of powered boats to find a safe mooring. This is because river flows are likely to strengthen and red boards could be displayed very soon and without warning.

When yellow boards **(CAUTION STREAM DECREASING)** are displayed on lock gates, they advise users of all unpowered boats not to navigate and users of powered boats to navigate with caution.

For updated information on warning boards, see –
<http://riverconditions.environment-agency.gov.uk/>

	For updated information on rates of flow at Kingston, see https://www.gaugemap.co.uk/#!/Detail/1249 FOG Fog can have a very significant effect on operations in some areas, particularly in the area of Eel Pie Island and then between Hammerton's Pier and Glover's Island. There is also a tendency for small but dense banks of fog to form throughout our area. Extreme caution is required in these conditions.
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Amendment History			
Date	*Version	Author / Contributor	Amendment Details
April 2023	3.0	Operations Manager (Lifeboats) (Tim Evans)	Added document classification, updated approver, updated sponsor, amended review date to biennial
		Wayne Bellamy (Station Manager)	Annual review (all changes highlighted)
February 2021	2.0	Operations Manager (Lifeboats) (Pete Murphy)	SHE Symbology reviewed Printed watermark added Version control implemented
		Neil Withers (ALM)	Periodic validation
January 2021	1.1	Jon Chapman, Greg Smith	Major re-write
September 2018	1.0	Jon Chapman	Existing LOP

***Version Control Note:** All documents in development are indicated by minor versions i.e. 0.1; 0.2 etc. The first version of each document to be approved for release is given a major version 1.0. Upon review, the first version of a revised document is given the designation 1.1, the second 1.2 etc. until the revised version is approved, whereupon it becomes version 2.0. The system continues in numerical order each time a document is reviewed and approved.